

NotebookLM: Learn Deeply from Trusted Sources

Turn a carefully selected source pack into a grounded tutor, research partner, study system, and creation studio.

Grounded chat

Inline citations

Active learning

Studio outputs

Current through June 10, 2026

Today's mission

Build one useful notebook, question its evidence, and transform it into learning materials you can actually use.

Source-first, not answer-first

Output: one complete learning notebook

Collecting documents is easy. Building understanding is the hard part.

Too much material

Reports, PDFs, videos, notes, slides, and websites pile up faster than we can read.

Facts are scattered

One answer may require connections across several sources.

Memory fades

Passive rereading feels productive but rarely proves mastery.

Generic AI guesses

A chatbot may answer beyond your trusted evidence or invent missing detail.

NotebookLM changes the starting question: not "What does AI know?" but "What can we understand from these sources?"

Sources

Policy PDF

Trusted primary document

Training slides

Existing explanation

Expert video

Transcript becomes a source

Your notes

Local context and insights

Grounded Chat

You: Where do these sources disagree?

NotebookLM: The policy requires quarterly review **1**, while the training slides describe monthly review **2**. The video does not specify timing **3**.

You: Explain the difference for a new staff member.

Studio

Study guide

Audio overview

Mind map

Quiz

Data table

Slide deck

NotebookLM is strongest when the answer must stay close to selected evidence.

It uses the sources in the current notebook as its knowledge base. Answers include inline citations that let you jump back to the supporting passage.

Evidence boundary

Source subset selection

Citation tracing

Cross-source synthesis

Grounded does not mean guaranteed

- A citation may not fully support the claim.
- A weak or biased source remains weak or biased.
- Missing information can produce incomplete conclusions.
- AI can misunderstand complicated tables or context.
- You still need to open citations and verify important claims.

Desktop NotebookLM accepts a wide range of source formats.

Files

PDFs, text, Markdown, Word and PowerPoint files, plus supported audio and images.

Google Drive

Google Docs, Slides up to 100 slides, and Sheets with current token limits.

Websites

Import readable webpage text; paywalls and unsupported pages may fail.

YouTube

Use public videos with available captions or transcripts.

Audio

Upload recordings such as MP3 or WAV and work from their content.

Copied text

Paste notes, messages, transcripts, or other safe content directly.

Per-source limit: 500,000 words or 200 MB local upload

No page limit stated

Images are supported sources

A focused source pack produces a more useful notebook.

1

Define the decision

What must the notebook help you understand, teach, compare, or decide?

2

Prefer originals

Use policies, research papers, official guidance, and firsthand records.

3

Add perspectives

Include sources that disagree or serve different audiences.

4

Name clearly

Use titles that reveal date, owner, subject, and version.

5

Remove noise

Exclude duplicates, obsolete drafts, and irrelevant material.

SOURCE AUDIT PROMPT

Review the selected sources. Create a table with source purpose, author or owner, date, likely strengths, likely limitations, and what important perspective is missing.

Fast Research

Enter a query in the Sources panel, review recommended web sources, read the short relevance descriptions, and choose which results to import.

Find credible sources about reducing teacher administrative workload in secondary schools. Prefer recent government, university, and recognized research organization sources.

Deep Research

An agentic research option can browse many websites, create a multi-page report, and let you review and import its relevant sources.

Over-18 feature

Usage limits depend on plan

Review before importing

Important: Discovery expands the notebook, but it does not replace source judgment. Inspect the report, cited pages, dates, and missing perspectives.

Good questions move from orientation to challenge to creation.

1

Orient

What are the major themes and terms?

2

Locate

Where is a specific rule, claim, or example?

3

Connect

How do sources support or contradict each other?

4

Challenge

What is weak, missing, uncertain, or biased?

5

Translate

Explain for a particular learner or audience.

6

Create

Transform the understanding into a useful output.

STRONG CHAT PROMPT

Using only the selected sources, explain the three most important agreements and two meaningful disagreements. Cite every point, distinguish evidence from interpretation, and tell me which conclusion is least certain.

What should you do after receiving a cited answer?

Trust it because a citation appears

Open the citation and check context

Add every available source

Challenge the answer's uncertainty

Choose an action and explain why before revealing the feedback.

The TRACE check

- **Text:** does the passage say this?
- **Relevance:** is it evidence for this exact claim?
- **Authority:** who created the source?
- **Currency:** is the date appropriate?
- **Exceptions:** what has been omitted?

Set a goal so chat answers fit your purpose and audience.

CUSTOM CHAT GOAL

Act as a patient learning coach for a beginner. Base every factual claim on the notebook sources. Ask one diagnostic question before explaining. Use simple English, one practical example, and a short self-check question. When sources disagree, show both views and do not force certainty.

Role

Audience

Evidence rule

Teaching method

Output style

Useful goals

- Socratic tutor
- Strict research reviewer
- Meeting-preparation coach
- Policy explainer
- Exam revision partner
- Writing feedback partner

● ● ● **NOTES BECOME THINKING MATERIAL**

Write your own notes

Capture interpretations, questions, examples, and decisions alongside the sources.

Save strong answers

Turn a useful chat response into a note. Saved response notes are not editable.

Transform notes

Combine, summarize, critique, outline, create a study guide, or convert notes into sources.

Collaboration and export

Written notes sync for notebook editors. Notes can be exported to Google Docs, while data tables can be exported to Google Sheets.

Current capacity

Google currently documents up to 1,000 notes per notebook. Treat notes as your reasoning layer, not a storage dump.

One source pack can become many different learning experiences.

Listen

Audio Overviews in several formats.

Watch

Video Overviews and visual explanation.

Map

Mind maps for concepts and connections.

Read

Reports, FAQs, study guides, briefings.

Practice

Flashcards and quizzes with feedback.

Present

Infographics, data tables, and slide decks.

Choose the artifact that matches the learning job. A podcast is good for orientation; a quiz is better for proving recall.

AUDIO OVERVIEWS

Format	Best use	Learning move
Deep Dive	Two-host conversation connecting important ideas	Listen before detailed reading to build orientation
The Brief	Fast single-speaker summary	Use for quick recap or meeting preparation
The Critique	Constructive evaluation of material	Identify weaknesses in an essay, plan, or argument
The Debate	Multiple perspectives and tensions	Explore disagreement without forcing consensus

Audio is a doorway into the source pack, not a substitute for evidence

Customize before generating

Specify the audience, topics to emphasize, perspective, depth, and output language. Some experiences allow interaction with the AI hosts.

Objective reflection of sources

Can still contain errors

● ● ● VIDEO, INFOGRAPHICS, AND SLIDE DECKS

Video Overview

Transforms sources into a visual deep dive. Useful for explaining complex material in a more engaging sequence.

Visual explanation

Review for accuracy

Infographic

Creates one visual summary to show key points, data, or relationships at a glance.

Single visual

Fast overview

Slide Deck

Generates a presentation from notebook sources, can be presented in NotebookLM, revised where supported, or shared as PDF.

Over-18 feature

Availability varies

Review rule: confirm claims, dates, charts, source coverage, audience fit, and whether the visual leaves out an important disagreement.

Use a mind map to see the structure before studying the details.

Mind Maps visually summarize sources as a branching diagram of main topics and connected ideas. They are useful for orientation, exploring relationships, and organizing memory.

FOLLOW-UP LEARNING MOVE

Choose one branch that feels unclear. Ask chat to explain the branch, compare it with another branch, cite the relevant sources, and give one real-world example.

Best for

- Seeing the big picture
- Finding a starting point
- Connecting concepts
- Planning an explanation
- Identifying missing branches

Not currently supported in the mobile app

Reports

Create a custom report or choose formats such as an FAQ, study guide, briefing document, or an AI-suggested report type.

Create a briefing for school leaders. Include the decision, evidence, disagreements, risks, unanswered questions, and a cited action checklist.

[Export to Google Docs](#)

Data Tables

Synthesize scattered details into structured rows and columns. Customize the language and describe exactly what each row and column should represent.

Create a table with each recommendation as a row and columns for source, evidence strength, cost, implementation difficulty, and unresolved question.

[Export to Google Sheets](#)

[Citations in a separate tab](#)

Flashcards and quizzes turn passive reading into active recall.

Customize

Choose easy, medium, or hard and describe audience, style, and focus.

Explain

Ask for explanations when a card or answer is unclear.

Track

Mark flashcards as "Got it" or "Missed it" and return later.

Review

See results, revisit errors, and retake the activity.

Better practice prompt

Create hard application questions for a new manager. Focus on choosing the correct action in realistic scenarios, not memorizing definitions. Explain why each wrong answer is tempting.

Do not stop at a summary. Make the notebook teach, test, and improve you.

1

Preview

Use summary, audio, or mind map.

2

Question

Ask what is important and confusing.

3

Explain

Restate ideas in your own words.

4

Retrieve

Use flashcards and quizzes.

5

Apply

Solve a realistic case or decision.

6

Verify

Open citations and repair mistakes.

LEARNING COACH PROMPT

Teach me this topic in three rounds. First diagnose what I know. Then explain only what I am missing using cited examples. Finally test me with one recall question, one comparison question, and one realistic application case.

GOAL

understand a difficult topic



AUDIENCE

a beginner professional

SOURCES

only the selected notebook source✓

OUTPUT

a cited learning guide



EXTRA RULES

Separate facts from interpretation, show uncertainty, and identify missing evidence.

Build prompt

Copy prompt

Your grounded NotebookLM prompt

Help me understand a difficult topic.

Audience: Create this for a beginner professional.

Evidence boundary: Use only the selected notebook sources. Base factual claims on the notebook and provide inline citations.

Output: Produce a cited learning guide.

Additional rules: Separate facts from interpretation, show uncertainty, and identify missing evidence.

Before finalizing:

1. Identify the most important agreements and disagreements.
2. Separate source evidence from your interpretation.
3. State which conclusion has the weakest support.
4. Identify missing perspectives or information.
5. Give me three citation-check questions so I can verify the result.

The same workflow supports learning, research, and real work.

Teachers

Study guides, lesson preparation, quizzes, source-grounded explanations.

Students

Revision plans, concept maps, active recall, cited research support.

Researchers

Literature comparison, evidence matrices, contradictions, open questions.

Managers

Policy briefings, meeting prep, decision tables, project knowledge bases.

Writers

Source organization, argument critique, outlines, and grounded drafts.

Teams

Shared onboarding, public explainers, common source packs, reusable FAQs.

Best fit: work where a known collection of documents should define the evidence. **Weak fit:** tasks requiring uncited imagination, confidential uploads without approval, or facts absent from the source pack.

● ● ● **SHARE AND COLLABORATE CAREFULLY**

Private notebook

A lock icon indicates the notebook has not been shared. Keep sensitive or unfinished work private.

Shared notebook

Add collaborators as viewers or editors where account and organization settings allow it.

Public notebook

Consumer accounts can share a link with anyone who has a Google account; public sharing is disabled for Enterprise and Education accounts.

Chat View is not an access-control barrier. It gives a focused view, but viewers may still be able to navigate to underlying sources and artifacts. Share only content you are allowed to expose.

Paid owners may access usage analytics

Notebook containing Gemini chats may be private and unshareable

Sharing changes the risk level of every source and artifact

Slide 21

Source control includes permission, privacy, and data handling.

Permission

Only upload material you are allowed to use and process.

Minimize

Remove personal, confidential, medical, financial, and identifying data.

Feedback caution

Providing feedback may share the interaction context for review.

Account rules

Work and school accounts follow their applicable Google terms and controls.

Google's current statement

Notebook content is not used to directly train foundational AI models unless the user chooses to provide feedback. Other connected Google services follow their own notices and privacy terms.

Always follow your organization's policy

● ● ● PLANS, LIMITS, AND AVAILABILITY

Standard account: current documented examples	Limit	What changes with paid or eligible Workspace access
Notebooks	100 per user	Higher notebook limits
Sources	50 per notebook	Higher source limits
Chats	50 per day	Higher daily chat limits
Audio and Video Overviews	3 per day each	Higher limits; cinematic video on some higher tiers
Reports, Flashcards, Quizzes, Mind Maps	10 per day each	Higher generation limits
Deep Research	10 per month	Higher daily limits
Data Tables, Infographics, Slide Decks	Limited	More limits, revisions, or advanced access depending on tier

Teach the workflow, not the quota

Limits and feature access are subject to change, region, age, account type, and plan. Check the learner's interface before planning an activity.

Newer premium access can move from understanding sources to performing complex analysis.

Advanced reasoning

Upgraded models can work through more complex research projects and show more of the reasoning process.

Secure cloud computer

NotebookLM can write and run code for deeper analysis within a controlled cloud environment.

Curated skills

More than 100 software skills support research, analysis, and transformation tasks.

New deliverables

Create custom reports, charts, spreadsheets, and slide decks directly from a research project.

Availability boundary

Google announced these upgrades on June 8, 2026 for Google AI Ultra and specific Workspace business accounts. Do not assume they appear in Standard, Plus, Pro, Education, or every region.

Premium / organization-specific

Verify access before teaching

NotebookLM mobile app

Useful for creating or opening notebooks, asking questions, reviewing flashcards and quizzes, viewing infographics and slide decks, and listening to downloaded Audio Overviews offline.

Desktop remains the full experience

Some source types and Studio features are limited

Sharing is limited in app

Notebooks in Gemini

Eligible Gemini users can create and use notebooks that sync sources with NotebookLM, then use NotebookLM-specific outputs such as Video Overviews and Infographics.

Gemini chat threads can become notebook context

Collaborators may see included Gemini chat context

Practical rule: build and organize on desktop; review, question, listen, and practice wherever access supports it.

The session moves from source judgment to active learning and creation.

00:00-00:25 **Why source grounding?** Problem story, NotebookLM model, and citation mindset.

01:05-01:15 **Break** Reset.

01:55-02:35 **Studio exploration** Generate audio, mind map, report, table, flashcards, and quiz.

02:45-03:35 **Capstone build** Create a complete learning or research notebook.

00:25-01:05 **Build the notebook** Choose, audit, upload, discover, and organize sources.

01:15-01:55 **Chat and verify** Question, compare, challenge, open citations, and save notes.

02:35-02:45 **Break** Reset.

03:35-04:00 **Share and reflect** Present one insight, citation, artifact, and limitation.

Use official Google guidance to verify changing features before each session.

NotebookLM Help Center

Current feature instructions, availability details, privacy guidance, and troubleshooting.

Plans and Limits

Current quotas and differences across Standard, Plus, Pro, Ultra, and Workspace access.

NotebookLM Product News

Official announcements for newly released capabilities and research workflows.

FACILITATOR CHECK BEFORE CLASS

Confirm account type, learner age eligibility, region, visible Studio outputs, generation limits, sharing permissions, and whether advanced research features are available.

Content status

This deck was written from official Google NotebookLM help and product announcements available on June 10, 2026.

Feature names can change

Limits are subject to change

Turn a trusted source pack into a complete understanding system.

1. Sources

At least three credible, relevant sources.

2. Chat

One comparison and one challenge prompt.

3. Verify

Open and inspect at least two citations.

4. Studio

Create two different learning artifacts.

5. Reflect

State one limitation and next evidence need.

Celebrate

Print / Save PDF

Exit ticket

1. What did the sources help you understand?
2. Which citation did you verify?
3. Which Studio artifact improved learning most?
4. What remains uncertain or missing?
5. What must you check before sharing?